

## The Columbian Exchange Key

1. What was the Columbian Exchange?

*A vast exchange of culture, plants, people, livestock, and even diseases between the Eastern and Western Hemispheres.*

2. Why was it called "Columbian"?

*Because this exchange was started by Columbus' voyages.*

3. What products moved from the "Old World" to the "New"?

a. Produce — *citrus fruits, peaches, pears, grapes, bananas, olives, onions, sugar cane, and coffee.*

b. Grains — *wheat, rice, barley and oats.*

c. Animals — *cattle, sheep, pigs and horses.*

d. Diseases — *smallpox, influenza, typhus, measles, malaria, diphtheria and whooping cough.*

4. What impact did the introduction of these diseases have on Native Americans?

*The natives of the New World had never been exposed to these diseases, and they had no immunity. This created epidemics and massive death tolls. It also contributed to the fall of the Aztec and Inca Empires.*

5. What was the death toll in Latin America?

*Scholars believe the population of the Aztec Empire to be 15 million in 1521, but only 2 million in 1581.*

6. What foods were exchanged from the "New World" to the "Old"?

*Potatoes, tomatoes, squash, corn, beans, avacados and peanuts.*

7. Why were corn and potatoes the most important?

*Both were easy and inexpensive to grow, and were very nutritious.*

8. Why was the potato particularly important?

*The potato in particular, became a staple food in many nations in Europe and in Asia. In fact, the potato did more to combat starvation and grow the world's population than any rulers or inventions had done.*

9. What "sweets" came from the Americas? And where did they become specialties?

*Both vanilla and cacao (chocolate) beans came from the Americas. Chocolate, of course, would become a specialty of certain European countries (Switzerland, Belgium... )*

10. What new drugs came from the Americas? What was their importance?

*Two drugs that came from the new world were tobacco and quinine. Quinine was later discovered to be effective against malaria. (Tobacco, of course, was not the helpful type of drug!)*